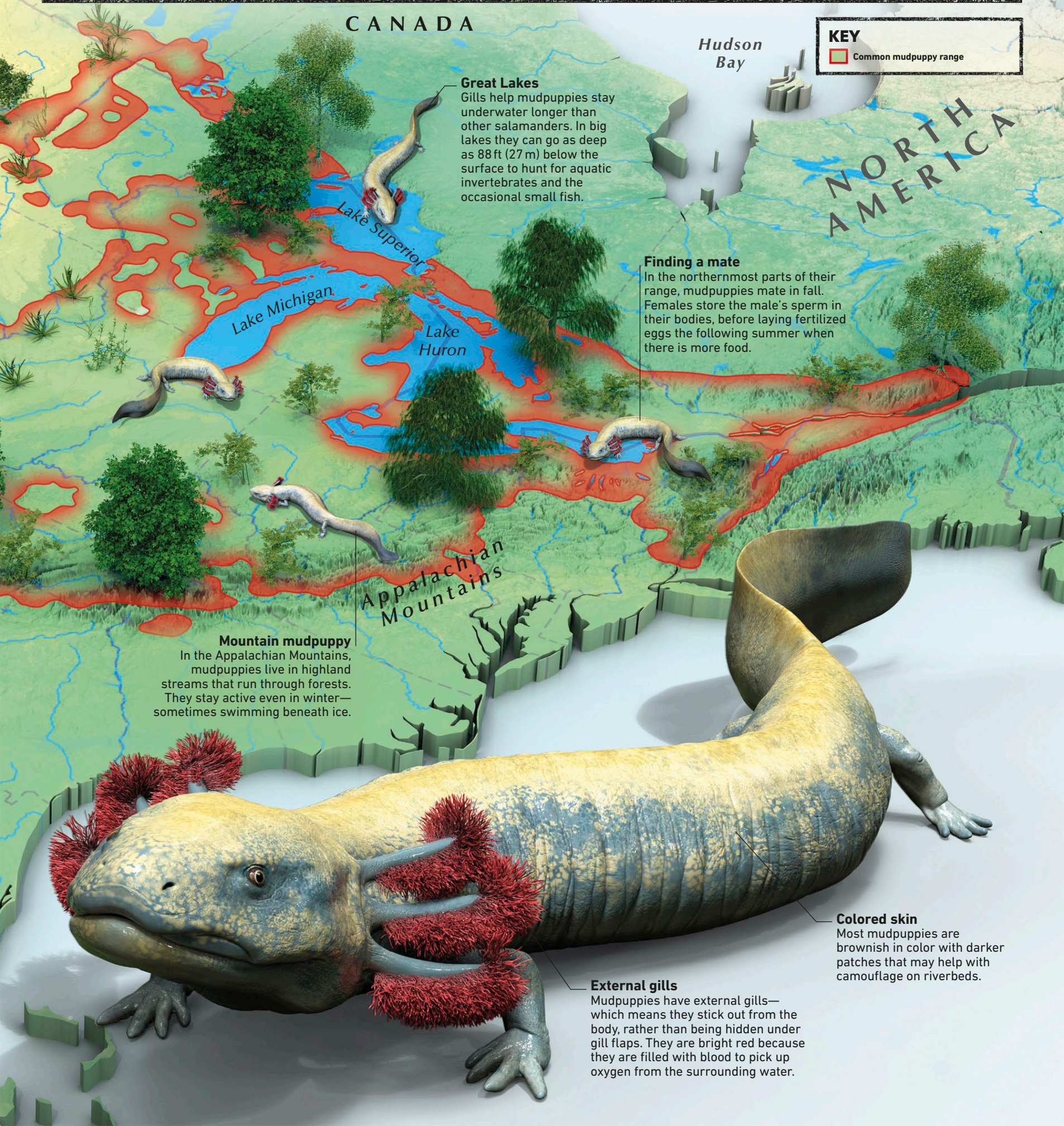


THERE ARE MORE THAN **750** SALAMANDER SPECIES IN THE WORLD



LIKE ALL OTHER AMPHIBIANS, **MUDPUPPIES** TAKE IN SOME **OXYGEN** DIRECTLY **THROUGH THEIR SKIN**



KEY

Common mudpuppy range

Great Lakes
Gills help mudpuppies stay underwater longer than other salamanders. In big lakes they can go as deep as 88 ft (27 m) below the surface to hunt for aquatic invertebrates and the occasional small fish.

Finding a mate
In the northernmost parts of their range, mudpuppies mate in fall. Females store the male's sperm in their bodies, before laying fertilized eggs the following summer when there is more food.

Mountain mudpuppy
In the Appalachian Mountains, mudpuppies live in highland streams that run through forests. They stay active even in winter—sometimes swimming beneath ice.

Colored skin
Most mudpuppies are brownish in color with darker patches that may help with camouflage on riverbeds.

External gills
Mudpuppies have external gills—which means they stick out from the body, rather than being hidden under gill flaps. They are bright red because they are filled with blood to pick up oxygen from the surrounding water.